Auto Delinquency Is at a Record, but It Is Not 2009

What it means for collections and used-vehicle remarketing | Data through 2026Q2 | Public data: NY Fed, FRED | Sharon Smith

5.49%
of auto balance 90+ late (record 5.60% in 2026Q1; 2010: 5.27%)

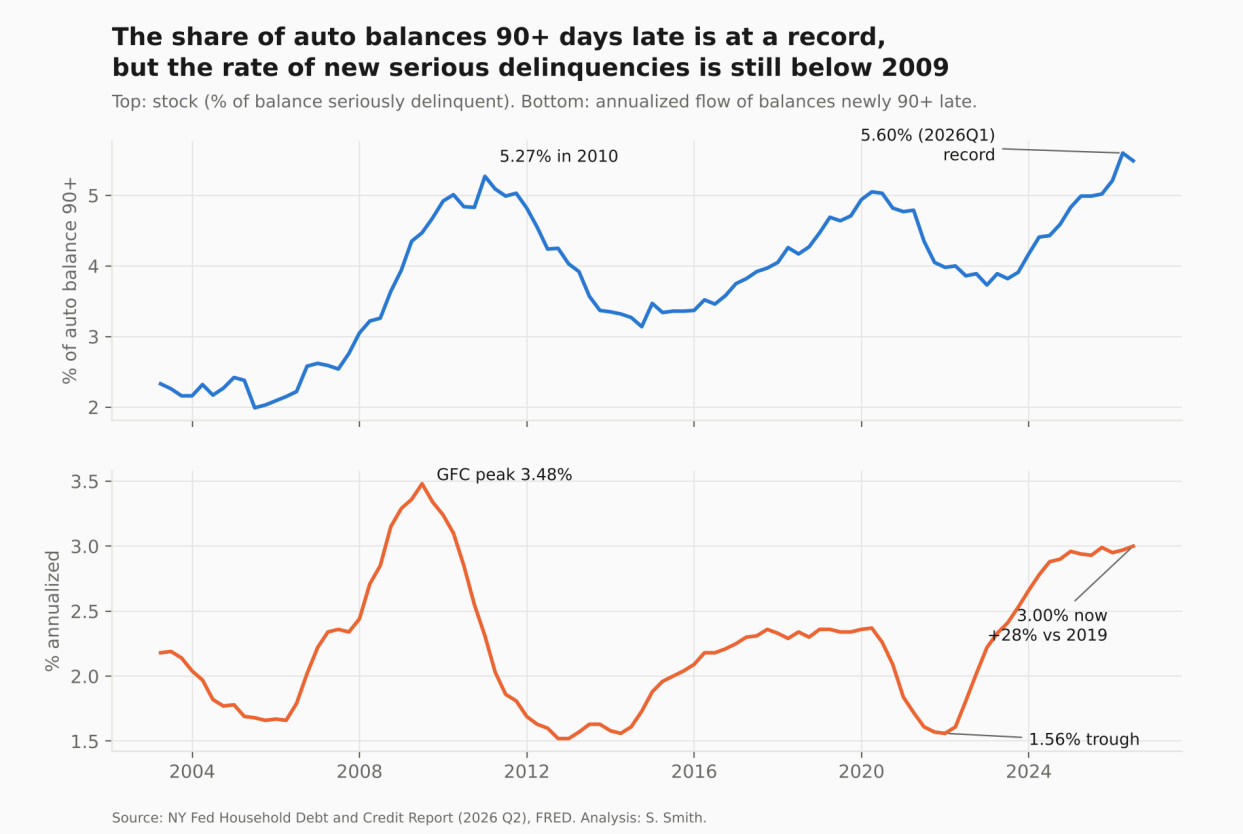
$94B
seriously delinquent, up 43% since end-2019

38.1%
of 30+ inflow rolls to 90+ (4th highest of 94 quarters)

13%
used prices below the level the 2022 vintage was written at

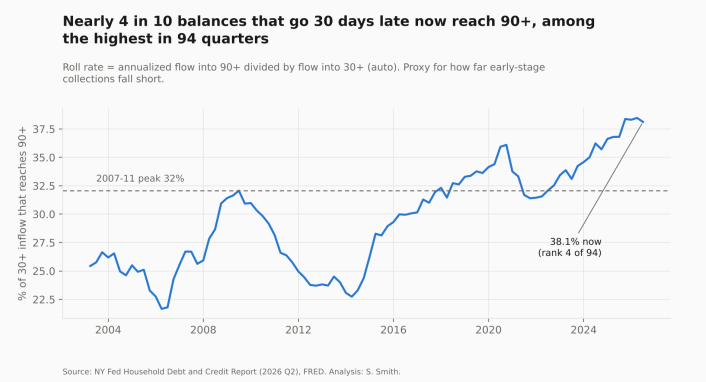
The point of view

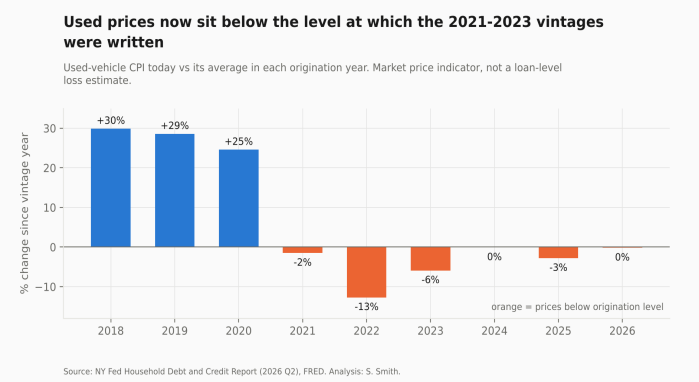
Fewer new loans are going seriously late than in 2009 (3.00% vs 3.48% annualized), credit mix is safer than 2006 (29% vs 44% subprime) and unemployment is 4.3%. Yet a record share of balances that go 30 days late now reaches 90+, and since mid-2024 the climb in the delinquent stock is 81% loans staying delinquent longer. That is a collections-effectiveness and remarketing-timing issue, and the 2021-2023 vintages sit on used prices that have fallen below origination levels.



What the data says

- **Inflow is 28% above 2019** (3.00% vs 2.35%) but flat since mid-2024 (up 4%).
- **Persistence rebuilt** from 1.54 years (2024Q2) to 1.83; still below 2019 (2.02).
- **Broad:** every age band is 21% to 33% above 2019. **Not unemployment:** 2009 inflow 3.24% came with 9.9% unemployment.





What to do

Action	Why
Lead collections KPI: 30-to-90 roll rate by vintage and score	Roll rate 38.1% vs 33.7% in 2019. Industry-scale, one point is about $1.3B a year reaching 90+; back to 2019 level is about $5.6B.
Early outreach on 2021-2023 vintages with large payments	Prices -2% / -13% / -6% vs origination year; payment size explains about 40% of the rise (Fed Board, 2024).
Plan remarketing capacity for later, lumpier inflow	Delinquent loans take longer to resolve (Philadelphia Fed, Apr 2026); persistence is rising again.
Stress recoveries with a price grid, not a forecast	No public-data model beat "same as now" (-3% best). A further 10% price drop is $2.4B to $7.0B of collateral value depending on repossession share.

Where I could be wrong

- These are industry aggregates for all lenders, not any one company's book; treat them as hypotheses for loan-level data.
- Roll rate and persistence are ratios of aggregate flows. Used-vehicle CPI is a consumer index, not auction recovery value. The repossession share in the grid is an assumption.
- The Philadelphia Fed argues headline delinquency overstates distress; this brief agrees on mechanics and differs on what it means for operations.

Method: tidy parse of 5,715 NY Fed observations and 333 FRED months; 15 SQL validation checks (all pass; tested to fail on corrupted data); headline numbers recomputed independently in pandas; 4 of 4 figures match NY Fed publications. Code, data, Power BI tables and DAX are in the repository.